

Who Pays and Who Decides: The Trial Run

谁承担，谁决定：第一次试行

Theme: 社会问题、经济与公共生活 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The trial run began with an **act** of the council and a **fund** of **real** money. “The **issue** is not the **answer**, it is the **order** of the questions,” the mayor said. “We will **assess** one ward, then decide.” **Security**, **welfare**, and **liability** were all in the **proclamation**, and so was the **obligatory payment** of two pounds a month.

The **finding** of the first week was a surprise: the **appeal** of the scheme was strongest among the poor. “They are not chasing **charity**,” the social worker said. “They are buying certainty.” A **complaint** from an **elite** household, a **pile** of forms, and a **monetary flaw** in the tariff were the first three items on the list.

The **truth** of the trial was that a small **payment** produced a large **satisfaction**. “The economy of a **wallet** is not the economy of a city,” the treasurer warned, “and a **boom** in small deposits can **float** a false confidence.” The point was written on the board in a **chip** of chalk.

The **discovery** of the second week was the **involvement** of the retailers. “Either the shop pays or the citizen does, **whereas** both of them already pay twice,” a shopkeeper said. The **handicapped** residents of the third ward were the group the scheme had missed entirely.

The **valid** objection came from the **defendant** in a pending case about the water bill. “A **competent** administration does not need **perfection**,” she said. “It needs a **flaw** it can admit.” The **authorization** for the second trial was signed the same afternoon.

The **containment** of the cost, the **answer** to the **liability** question, and the **announcement** of the next stage were the three things the meeting produced. “There is no **support** in a **proclamation**,” Lin wrote. “There is **support** in a **payment** that arrives every month.” The point of the trial was simple, and it had to be shown. We had to pick between a **force** and an argument, and between a **thing** and a promise. “Introduce the **payment**, show the **evidence**, and let the meeting decide,” the mayor said. It was the same **party** and the same poor ward, either way, and someone within the **world** of city hall had to be wrong first. As an **institution**, the council was **liable** for the **imposition** of the fee, and a **turkey** dinner was not the **answer**.

中文翻译

试行以议会的一项法案和一笔真金白银的基金开始。“问题不在答案，而在问题的次序，”市长说，“我们先评估一个选区，再作决定。”安全、福利与责任都写进了那份公告，强制性的每月两英镑缴款也在其中。

第一周的发现令人意外：这套方案在穷人中最有吸引力。“他们不是在追慈善，”社工说，“他们是在买确定性。”一户精英家庭的投诉、一堆表格，以及费率中一处货币上的缺陷，是清单上的头三项。

试行的真相是：一笔小额付款产生了很大的满足感。“钱包的经济学不是城市的经济学，”司库警告说，“小额存款的繁荣可以托起一种虚假的信心。”这一点被用一截粉笔写在了黑板上。

第二周的发现是零售商的卷入。“要么店主付，要么市民付，然而两者早已付了两次，”一位店主说。第三选区的残疾居民，是这套方案完全漏掉的群体。

有效的异议来自一位待审水费案中的被告。“一个称职的行政当局不需要完美，”她说，“它需要一个它敢于承认的缺陷。”第二次试行的授权在当天下午就签了字。

成本的抑制、责任问题的答案，以及下一阶段的公告，是这次会议产出的三样东西。“公告里没有支持，”林伟写道，“支持在于每个月按时到来的一笔付款。”这次试行的要点很简单，而且必须被展示出来。我们必须以一种力量与一个论证之间、在一件东西与一个承诺之间做选择。“引入这笔付款，把证据拿出来，让会议决定，”市长说。无论怎么选，都是同一个党和同一个贫困选区，而市政厅这个世界里必须有人先出错。作为一个机构，议会要为这项费用的征收负责，而一顿火鸡晚餐不是答案。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
issue 'isju POS: n	n. 发行, 问题, 后果, 流出, 出口, 争端; vi. 发行, 流出, 造成...结果, 传下; vt. 使流出, 放出, 发行, 发布... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an important question that is in dispute and must be settled; n. one of a series published periodically; n. ...
real 'riəl POS: a	a. 真的, 真实的, 实际的, 实在的, 不动(产)的, 实数的; n. 实数, 现实; adv. 真正地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the basic unit of money in Brazil; equal to 100 centavos; n. an old small silver Spanish coin; a. being or o...
order 'ɔ:de POS: n	n. 次序, 规则, 命令; vi. 命令, 定货; vt. 整理, 命令, 订购; n. 顺序, 阶数; [计] 顺序, 阶数 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (often plural) a command given by a superior (e.g., a military or law enforcement officer) that must be ob...
act ækt POS: n	n. 行动, 行为, 幕, 法案; vi. 行动, 表演, 假装, 见效, 表现, 担当; vt. 扮演, 装作; [计] 先进通信技术, 先进... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a legal document codifying the result of deliberations of a committee or society or legislative body; n. so...
support sə'pɔ:t POS: n	n. 支持, 支撑, 援助, 供养, 支撑物; vt. 支援, 支撑, 帮助, 支持, 忍受, 供养, 证实; [计] 后援; 支持 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of providing for or maintaining by supplying with money or necessities; n. aiding the cause or...
security si'kjʊrɪti POS: n	n. 安全, 安全性, 防护物, 保安, 可靠性, 担保人, 抵押品, 保证金; [计] 安全性, 保密性, 安全检查程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being free from danger or injury; n. defense against financial failure; financial independence...
fund fʌnd POS: n	n. 基金, 资金, 存款, 财源, 贮藏; vt. 提供资金, 积累 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a reserve of money set aside for some purpose; v. convert (short-term floating debt) into long-term debt th...
answer 'ɑ:nse POS: n	n. 答案, 回答, 回报, 答辩; vt. 回答, 反驳, 适应, 响应, 符合; vi. 回答, 答应, 负责, 符合, 成功; [计] 用... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a statement (either spoken or written) that is made to reply to a question or request or criticism or accu...
truth tru:θ POS: n	n. 事实, 实情; [法] 真实, 真相, 事实 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fact that has been verified; n. conformity to reality or actuality; n. a true statement; n. United States a...
institution .ɪnstɪ'tju:fən POS: n	n. 机构, 惯例, 制度; [医] 机关, 机构, 设施 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an organization founded and united for a specific purpose; n. an establishment consisting of a building or...
appeal ə'pi:l POS: n	n. 恳求, 诉请, 上诉, 吸引力; vi. 呼吁, 诉请, 要求, 上诉, 有吸引力; vt. 将...上诉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. attractiveness that interests or pleases or stimulates; n. (law) a legal proceeding in which the appellant...
payment 'peɪmənt POS: n	n. 付款, 支付的款项(或实物), 偿还, 报应, 惩罚; [经] 支付, 缴纳, 支付款额 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sum of money paid or a claim discharged; n. the act of paying money
finding 'faɪndɪŋ POS: n	n. 发现, 发现物, 决定, 裁决; [法] 调查结果, 对事实的认定, 判定的要素 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the decision of a court on issues of fact or law; n. something that is found
assess ə'ses POS: vt	vt. 估定, 对...征税, 评定; [经] 估计, 估价, 确定(税款罚款等)的金额 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. charge (a person or a property) with a payment, such as a tax or a fine; v. estimate the value of (property)...
whereas hwɛər'æz POS: conj	conj. 然而, 鉴于; [法] 考虑到, 鉴于, 就...而论 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: adv. At which place; where.; conj. Considering that; it being the case that; since; —; used to introduce a...
defendant dɪ'fendənt POS: n	n. 被告; [经] 被告方 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person or institution against whom an action is brought in a court of law; the person being sued or accu...
welfare 'welʃə POS: n	n. 福利, 安宁, 幸福, 福利事业; a. 福利的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n governmental provision of economic assistance to persons in need; n something that aids or promotes well-being...
liability laɪə'bɪlɪti POS: n	n. 责任, 债务, 倾向; [经] 责任, 义务, 负债 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being legally obliged and responsible; n. the quality of being something that holds you back
complaint kəm'pleɪnt POS: n	n. 诉苦, 抱怨, 控诉; [医] 陈诉; 病 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (formerly) a loud cry (or repeated cries) of pain or rage or sorrow; n. an expression of grievance or resen...
charity 'tʃærɪti POS: n	n. 慈悲, 博爱, 慈善团体, 施舍; [法] 宽大, 宽恕, 慈善机关 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a foundation created to promote the public good (not for assistance to any particular individuals); n. a ki...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
involvement in'vɒlvment POS: n	n. 卷入, 牵连, 包含, 困窘; [经] 财政困难, 经济上的困窘 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a connection of inclusion or containment
chip tʃɪp POS: n	n. 屑片, 薄片, 碎片; vt. 削, 切, 削成碎片, 使摔倒, 凿; vi. 削下屑片; [计] 孔屑; 组件; 晶片; 芯片 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a triangular wooden float attached to the end of a log line; n. a piece of dried bovine dung; n. a thin cris...
discovery dis'kʌvəri POS: n	n. 发现, 被发现的事物; [法] 要求告知, 发现, 发觉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of discovering something; n. something that is discovered; n. a productive insight; n. (law) compulso...
satisfaction ,sætɪs'fækʃən POS: n	n. 满足, 满意, 快事, 赔偿, 赎罪, 报仇的机会; [经] 偿还, 赎回 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the contentment one feels when one has fulfilled a desire, need, or expectation; n. (law) the payment of a...
elite ei'li:t POS: n	n. 精华, 精锐, 中坚分子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group or class of persons enjoying superior intellectual or social or economic status
announcement ə'naʊnsmənt POS: n	n. 公告, 发表, 告知; [经] 通告, 布告, 公告 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a formal public statement; n. a public statement containing information about an event that has happened or...
monetary 'mʌnɪtəri POS: a	a. 货币的, 金钱的; [经] 货币的, 金融的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or involving money
pile paɪl POS: n	n. 堆, 大堆, 大厦, 建筑群, 电池, 大量, 桥桩, 软毛, 痔疮; vi. 堆起, 堆积, 积累, 挤, 猛烈攻击; vt. 堆于, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a collection of objects laid on top of each other; n. a large sum of money (especially as pay or profit); n. ...
float fleʊt POS: n	n. 漂流物, 浮舟, 漂浮, 浮萍, 彩车; vi. 浮动, 飘动, 散播, 摇摆, 动摇, 浮动; vt. 使漂浮, 容纳, 淹没, 发行... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the time interval between the deposit of a check in a bank and its payment; n. the number of shares outstan...
boom bu:m POS: n	n. 繁荣, 隆隆声; vi. 急速发展, 发隆隆声; vt. 使兴旺, 发隆隆声 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a deep prolonged loud noise; n. a state of economic prosperity; n. a sudden happening that brings good fortu...
valid 'vælid POS: a	a. 有确实根据的, 有法律效力的, 正当的, 正确的; [经] 有效的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. well grounded in logic or truth or having legal force; s. still legally acceptable
turkey 'tɜ:ki POS: n	n. 火鸡, 无用的家伙, 土耳其 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. large gallinaceous bird with fan-shaped tail; widely domesticated for food; n. a Eurasian republic in Asia...
liable 'laɪəbl POS: a	a. 有义务的, 应负责的, 有...倾向的; [法] 有责任的, 可受处理的, 应受罚的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. subject to legal action; s. (often followed by 'to') likely to be affected with; s. held legally responsible
chase tʃeɪs POS: n	n. 追求, 狩猎, 追逐; vt. 追捕, 追逐, 雕刻, 在...上镶嵌宝石; vi. 追赶, 奔跑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. United States politician and jurist who served as chief justice of the United States Supreme Court (1808-1...
competent 'kɒmpɪtənt POS: a	a. 能干的, 胜任的, 有效的, 足够的; [经] 有权的, 授权的, 胜任的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. properly or sufficiently qualified or capable or efficient; s. adequate for the purpose; a. legally qualifie...
flaw flɔ:ɪ POS: n	n. 缺点, 裂纹, 瑕疵, 一阵狂风; [化] 划痕; 裂缝; 裂纹 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. defect or weakness in a person's character; n. an imperfection in a plan or theory or legal document that c...
wallet 'wɒlɪt POS: n	n. 皮夹; [法] 皮包, 皮夹, 钱袋 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a pocket-size case for holding papers and paper money
handicapped 'hændɪkæpt POS: a	a. 残疾的; [法] 有生理缺陷的, 残废的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n people collectively who are crippled or otherwise physically handicapped; v injure permanently; v attempt to...
perfection pə'fekʃən POS: n	n. 完美, 完成, 极端; [经] 完整性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being without a flaw or defect; n. the act of making something perfect
imposition ,ɪmpə'zɪʃən POS: n	n. 征收, 课税, 强加, 欺骗; [经] 征税, 税, 税款 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of imposing something (as a tax or an embargo); n. an uncalled-for burden
containment kən'teɪnmənt POS: n	n. 抑制, 牵制, 遏制; [法] 抑制, 牵制, 遏制 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a policy of creating strategic alliances in order to check the expansion of a hostile power or ideology or...
authorization ,ɔ:θəraɪ'zeɪʃən POS: n	n. 授权, 许可; [经] 授权, 许可, 批准 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of conferring legality or sanction or formal warrant

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
proclamation ˌprɒkleɪ'meɪʃən POS: n	n. 宣言, 公布, 布告, 公告; [法] 宣告, 宣布, 布告 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the formal act of proclaiming; giving public notice
obligatory ɒb'lɪɡətəri POS: a	a. 义务的, 必须的, 强制性的; [法] 有拘束的, 强制的, 必须的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. morally or legally constraining or binding; s. required by obligation or compulsion or convention